

Word family: **texture / textures / textured / textural**

Base word: texture

Plural: textures

Related forms: textured, textural

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / adjective-related forms (相關形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “What I admire most is that he can take a small, everyday scene and turn it into a story with **texture**, humour, and meaning.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **texture** is figurative. It means that the story has **richness, depth, variation, and many small details that make it feel vivid and layered rather than flat or simple**.

繁體中文： ** **內容中包含豐富而細緻的層次、變化和具體細節，使故事顯得立體、有質感而不單薄**

中文翻譯：

> “...turn it into a story with **texture**, humour, and meaning.”

「.....把它說成一個有**層次和質感**、有幽默感、也有意義的故事。」

Here:

texture = 內容具有豐富細節、層次和變化，使整體感覺更立體、更有深度

1. **texture = how a surface feels (表面觸感) — 質感；觸感**

This is the basic physical meaning.

Meaning: The way the surface of something feels when touched, especially whether it is smooth, rough, soft, hard, etc.

Practice 1

> “The fabric has a soft, smooth **texture**.”

「這種布料的**質感 / 觸感**柔軟而光滑。」

Practice 2

> “I like the rough **texture** of natural stone.”

「我喜歡天然石材粗糙的**表面質感**。」

texture = 物件表面給人觸摸時產生的感覺，例如光滑、粗糙、柔軟或凹凸

Common:

- * rough texture
- * smooth texture
- * soft texture
- * grainy texture

These are one underlying physical sense.

2. **texture** = structure/consistency of food or material (食物 / 物料) — 口感；質地

Texture also describes the internal physical quality or consistency of food and other materials.

Practice 3

> “The cake has a light, fluffy **texture**.”

「這個蛋糕的**口感 / 質地**輕盈鬆軟。」

Practice 4

> “The sauce should have a thick, creamy **texture**.”

「這個醬汁應該有濃厚而幼滑的**質地 / 口感**。」

texture = 食物或物料本身呈現的物理結構和稠度，例如鬆軟、幼滑、脆、黏稠等

For learners, this is worth keeping explicit because Chinese often becomes **口感** rather than **觸感**.

That said, semantically it still develops from the broader physical idea of:

> **how something physically feels**

So for core counting, I would usually merge this with Meaning 1 unless your database wants food/material texture as a practical subtype.

3. **texture** = visible surface quality/pattern (視覺表面) — 紋理；表面質感

Texture can also be perceived visually rather than by touch.

Practice 5

> “The photograph captures the **texture** of the old brick wall.”

「這張照片捕捉到舊磚牆的**紋理 / 表面質感**。」

Practice 6

> “The designer added visual **texture** to the background.”

「設計師在背景加入了視覺**紋理 / 質感**。」

texture = 表面在視覺上呈現的細小紋路、粗細、凹凸或材料感

Common in:

- * art
- * photography
- * graphic design
- * interior design

This is related to physical texture, but because the perception is visual rather than tactile, it is useful to teach explicitly.

4. **texture** = richness/layering in writing, music, art, experience (內容層次) — 層次；質感；豐富度

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: The presence of varied, subtle, and detailed elements that give something depth, richness, or complexity.

Practice 7 — Original

> “He can turn a small, everyday scene into a story with **texture**, humour, and meaning.”

「他可以把一個日常小場面說成一個有**層次和質感**、有幽默感、也有意義的故事。」

Practice 8

> “The novel has emotional **texture** because even the minor characters feel real.”

「這本小說很有情感**層次**，因為就連小角色也令人覺得真實。」

Practice 9

> “The music gains **texture** from the combination of different instruments.”

「不同樂器的結合令音樂更有**層次和豐富感**。」

texture = 作品或經驗中由細節、變化、對比和多層元素形成的豐富感與深度

This is clearly figurative and deserves a separate meaning.

5. **texture** = arrangement of musical sounds/layers (音樂結構) — 織體；聲部層次

In music, **texture** has a more specific established meaning.

Meaning: The way different melodic lines, voices, instruments, or sound layers are combined.

Practice 10

> “The piece has a dense musical **texture**.”

「這首樂曲具有濃密的音樂**織體 / 聲部層次**。」

Practice 11

> “The composer creates a lighter **texture** by using fewer instruments.”

「作曲家透過減少樂器數量，創造出較輕盈的音樂**織體**。」

musical texture = 不同旋律線、聲部、樂器或聲音層次彼此組合的方式

This is an established technical-but-common arts meaning.

Because the learner concept is more specific than general figurative richness, I would keep it explicit.

Related form: **textured**

Textured means having a noticeable surface pattern or physical/visual texture.

Practice 12

> “The wall has a **textured** finish.”

「這面牆有帶明顯紋理的**質感表面**。」

Practice 13

> “She chose a **textured** fabric for the curtains.”

「她為窗簾選了一種有明顯**紋理 / 質感**的布料。」

textured = 表面具有明顯紋理、凹凸或質感的

Related form: **textural**

Textural means relating to texture.

Practice 14

> “The painting is interesting because of its **textural** contrasts.”

「這幅畫因不同表面**質感 / 紋理的對比**而很有趣。」

Practice 15

> “The chef focused on **textural** variety.”

「廚師很重視不同**口感和質地**的變化。」

textural = 與物件、食物、藝術或聲音的**質感 / 紋理 / 層次**有關的

Important distinction: **texture vs surface**

surface

= the outer part of something

texture

= the quality or feel of that surface

> “The table has a wooden surface.”

= 桌面是木製的。

> “The table has a rough texture.”

= 桌面的觸感很粗糙。

So:

****surface = 表面本身****

****texture = 表面的質感 / 觸感 / 紋理****

Important distinction: ****texture vs pattern****

**pattern**

usually refers to repeated shapes, lines, colours, or designs.

**texture**

refers to how the surface looks or feels.

A wall can have:

> a striped ****pattern****

and:

> a rough ****texture****

at the same time.

Important distinction: ****texture vs consistency****

Especially for food:

**texture**

broader sensory quality:

- * creamy
- * crunchy
- * soft
- * chewy

consistency

often focuses more narrowly on thickness, firmness, or how uniform a substance is.

> “The soup has a thick consistency.”

> “The bread has a chewy texture.”

There is overlap, but they are not identical.

Important distinction: **texture vs detail**

This is especially relevant to your passage.

detail

= an individual small feature

texture

= the richer overall effect created by many details, contrasts, layers, and variations

So:

> a story may contain many **details**

and those details together may give it:

> **texture**

That is exactly what happens in your original sentence.

Important distinction: **texture vs depth**

They overlap figuratively.

depth

usually emphasizes complexity, seriousness, or deeper meaning.

texture

emphasizes richness created by multiple small layers, details, tones, and variations.

A story can therefore have:

- * depth of meaning
- * texture of detail and atmosphere

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- * **texture**
- * **textures**
- * **textured**
- * **textural**

Useful expressions include:

- * surface texture
- * food texture
- * visual texture
- * musical texture
- * emotional texture
- * textural contrast

The Golden Manual says domain-specific meanings should be included when they are established, modern, and genuinely distinct enough to help learners.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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texture — tactile surface quality	物件表面給人觸摸時產生的質感，例如光滑、粗糙、柔軟或凹凸
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texture — food/material consistency	食物或材料呈現出的物理質地和口感，例如鬆軟、幼滑、脆或黏稠	
texture — visual surface quality	表面在視覺上呈現出的紋理、粗細、凹凸或材料感	
texture — figurative richness/layering	作品、故事或經驗因包含多層細節、變化、對比和細微元素而產生的豐富感與深度	
musical texture	不同旋律線、聲部、樂器或聲音層次彼此組合的方式	
textured	表面具有明顯紋理、凹凸或質感的	
textural	與質感、紋理、口感或聲音層次有關的	

For your original sentence

> “...turn it into a story with **texture**, humour, and meaning.”

The exact meaning is:

texture = 故事因包含很多細微細節、層次、對比和變化，而顯得豐富、立體和有深度

So:

> **a story with texture**

= **一個有豐富層次和細緻質感的故事**

For your database, I would count **4 genuinely useful core meanings** for **texture**:

1. **physical/tactile surface quality**
2. **visual surface quality/pattern**
3. **figurative richness, depth, and layering in a work or experience**
4. **music — arrangement of sound/voice/instrument layers**

I would usually merge **food texture** into #1 as a physical-sensory subtype rather than create another core meaning, though it is useful enough to show separately in the entry because the natural Chinese gloss becomes **口感 / 質地**.